Sophie Krajmalnik sophie.krajmalnik@unt.edu Transfer Ambassador

Spring 2027 Transfer Communities

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Past Communities

Fall 2025: Spirit Community

This community was a legacy community that I picked up for the semester. Students attended UNT events like football games, UPC events, and more for 4 sessions. The average turnout was between 1 to 4 people.

Spring 2026: Crafty Community

This community was my proposal for the Spring semester, where we partnered with different campus organizations and departments to have crafting workshops. The average turnout was between 1 to 2 people. We made felt pennants with the Union Arts Center, did printmaking with PANTS, had an embroidery workshop with the Spark Makerspace, and hosted our own "Bring Your Own Craft" night.

Fall 2026: Intramural Volleyball

This community was a legacy community co-led with Madi and Trinity. We formed a team for Intramural Volleyball and played in the Open league, with practices during our season as well. The average turnout was between 2 to 6 people.

Findings

1) Spring semester is slower than Fall as that is not the traditional start of yearly programming and there are less transfer students.
2) Matching availability and consistent meetings are key, as the regularly scheduled meetings and communities tend to have stronger turnout since students can plan better.
3) Interest does not indicate turnout, as students tend to have high hopes and intentions in the beginning and are feeling things out, then do not show up for the actual event.
4) Staple programs like volleyball and Transfer Games seem to perform better as cornerstones of involvement.
5) Programs should connect to resources, provide evident benefits, and create friendships.

Goals

1) Keep continuing transfer students engaged with Transfer Center programming.
2) Invite new transfer students to get involved.
3) Develop methods of outcome evaluation to complement my data science background.
4) Create staple programs that the Transfer Center can continue to implement.

Transfer Tuesday Crafts

Summary: As the Crafty Community transitioned to being wrapped into Transfer Tuesday for Fall 2026, we can continue having intermittent crafts in Transfer Tuesday to offer a new way for students to engage with Transfer Center programming.

Opportunity:

- While not a traditional community, this builds the required skills by considering transfer student needs, connecting to resources, planning and executing the programs (including budgeting), logistics (preparation, set-up, create systems), and marketing.
- Continuing this creates a consistent expectation in Transfer Tuesdays and leverages the preparations made in Fall 2026.

Potential Issues:

- Budget – We have cut down to 4 crafts to keep costs low and budget is considered in programming.
- Interest – Engagement has been low for Transfer Tuesday crafts, but attendance is very variable for Transfer Center programs. Stronger marketing initiatives can be taken to present this as a community and push for attendance, which will also bolster Transfer Tuesday attendance.
- Timing – Students who already cannot attend Transfer Tuesdays cannot be drawn into the program and do not have the opportunity to form a specific cohort. Additionally, spreading out the programs means it can be challenging to build momentum.

Program Series

January: Planner Prep & Goal Punch Cards

Students have stickers and other school supplies to decorate their planner or make a punch card to keep them accountable for their New Year's resolutions in a fun way. They can also view resources from the **UNT Career Center** and **The Learning Center** about goal-setting.

February: Valentine's Day Crafts - Cards and Paper Chains

Students will make cards and paper chains to decorate for Valentine's Day and will get a Valentine from the **Transfer Center**. They can also view resources from the **UNT Diamond Eagle Student Resources Center** and be encouraged to give back to the community they love.

March: Bandanas

As Spring and festival season approaches, students will be able to decorate a bandana to use as an accessory. They can also view resources on Spring Break safety from the **UNT Student Health and Wellness Center**.

April: Earth Day Craft – Pipe Cleaner Flowers

Students will make pipe cleaner flowers to celebrate Earth Day and can view resources from the **UNT Sustainable Arts Garden**.

Fitness Events

Summary: This community provides students a low-stakes opportunity to participate in fitness and wellness events with Spring in the air, attending guided group fitness classes,

getting outside with Outdoor Pursuits, and wrapping up with cheering on our team at a basketball game. It combines exposure to more fitness and wellness resources, community bonding, and movement.

Opportunity:

- This series of events provides more variety than an intramural sport.
- This combines more active participation with casual opportunities to connect and make friends.
- These activities are great for seasonal engagement and bring in some of the Spirit Community activities like going to an athletics event.

Potential Issues:

- Booking classes – We risk people missing the opportunity to sign up or not having enough room if we just sign up for a public class. We can communicate with the Rec Center to see if we can reserve a block for a class under a Transfer Ambassador or we can attempt to book a private class, which they offer.
- Overlap with intramurals – This might appeal to the same population and, depending on timing, might not allow for participation in both. Additionally, if it appeals to the same group of students, it does not expand the population that is interested in and participates in Transfer Communities. However, we can work scheduling around intramurals, have an opportunity to get people more invested in the Transfer Center even if they are in multiple communities, and offer more casual events that can bring in new people.
- Cost vs. Attendance – Booking classes for our individual program guarantees that we will have no issues with getting everyone in, but with the understanding that attendance might be low, it might not be cost-effective.
- Host timing – We are dependent on when events we are attending are going on. We only would have control over private bookings.

Program Series

Program 1: Pilates Class - Pohl Rec Center

Program 2: Campfire Social - Outdoor Pursuits

Program 3: Yoga Class – Pohl Rec Center/Transfer Tuesday

Program 4: Attend Basketball Game – Mean Green Athletics

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Leadership Transfers!

Summary: A 4-week professional development course building the most transferable skill: leadership! Campus partners will speak about their opportunities and host workshops, and students will develop skills, grow as a cohort, and have tangible outcomes.

Opportunity:

- Transfer students do not have as much time to get acquainted with organizations and build roots to grow in organizations and step into leadership roles on campus.
- Most leadership development programs are either geared towards people already in leadership (SOLD, CEO Prep) or to underclassmen (FLiP, UNT Leads).
- Various leadership programs are offered through different departments at UNT but are not well-advertised to students or do not collaborate with each other.
- Students can have a tangible certificate of completion to put on their LinkedIn.
- The Transfer Center will be able to develop working relationships with more organizations and departments on campus, which will connect students and allow for more programs in the future.

Potential Issues:

- Competing programs like CEO Prep, Emerging Leaders, LeadershipAND, etc. - Our difference is maintaining a presence with transfer students, working with different organizations and promoting these programs, and serving as a launchpad for transfer students.
- Balancing partnerships – We will collaborate with partners to ensure they are comfortable contributing to this program, putting their name on it, and will provide initial program outlines to meet goals and ease workloads.
- Timing – We will begin outreach before Winter Break to ensure there is enough time to execute a high-quality program.
- The Center for Leadership Development – We will ensure that they do not feel like we are encroaching upon their territory, collaborate with them, and present this program as a resource for resources.
- Build Your Brand – This program can be adapted to be wrapped into Build Your Brand or serve as a standalone. BYB can be evaluated to determine how this program would interact with it.

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Program Series

Program 1: Opportunity is Everywhere!

Summary: Students will be able to discover different leadership and involvement opportunities on campus and walk away with a structured format of how to get involved.

Transfer Ambassadors will prepare a presentation on what they are involved in, their leadership journey, and how being a Transfer Ambassador has helped them as a leader. This will provide students with a contact for different organizations, awareness of opportunities they might not have seen before, and will prepare for next year's TA recruiting cycle.

Involvement Ambassadors will give a presentation on their role, categories of organizations offered around campus, and how to make an appointment with them.

This presentation could take on the format of a magazine personality assessment for people to find what suits their personality.

Students will walk away with different ways to be involved on campus and a roadmap of missions they can take on for a prize, such as:

- Have coffee with a professor (Coffee & Convos)
- Attend a club meeting
- Meet with a Transfer Ambassadors (drive Eagle Connections appointments)
- Volunteer
- Update your LinkedIn
- Create a personal portfolio
- Attend an involvement appointment
- Apply or run for a leadership position
- Attend a LeadershipAND seminar
- Lead a group activity or study session

Prizes could include custom UNT merch, a gift card, school supplies giveaway, or others depending on budget.

Program 2: Systems That Work

Summary: Students discuss the leadership qualities of time management, accountability, and doing what you said you would.

The Learning Center will give a presentation on time management and students will have an opportunity to work with different templates of planners and other systems.

This presentation could give students an opportunity to share what they do in an average week and what's on their plate or be presented with an example persona. They then must search through example templates and planners and present the pros and cons of using that to organize themselves. Finally, they can implement different planners throughout the week on their own.

Program 3: Buy-In and Being Someone People Follow

Summary: This program will cover influence, networking, credibility, building and managing a team that backs you, and guiding a group towards a mission.

The **Center for Leadership Development's LEAD Mentors** will give a presentation on the session's topics.

The students will then play a board game that puts into practice building a team and influencing people, such as The Resistance or Coup, which can be rented from the Media Library.

Program 4: Turning Involvement into a Career Story

Summary: This program will cover resume and interview practice, LinkedIn optimization, and developing a personal pitch.

The Career Center will provide feedback and a presentation on the session's topics.

Professional Leadership Program will pitch their program as an opportunity to bridge education, involvement, and career outcomes. Part of their program is pitching to courses and organizations, so we can directly ask the program if any members can use this for one of their recruitment sessions.